

MARKETING PLAN · 90 DAYS · ONE CLIENT

# ₹25,000 a month. One client. Ninety days.

An honest, fully costed acquisition plan for a two-person part-time software company selling into Europe on a small budget — what to buy, what to refuse, what to send, and the arithmetic behind all of it.



MONTHLY BUDGET

**₹20–25,000**

≈ €210–265

TARGET

**1 paying client**

by day 90

CHANNELS FUNDED

**3 of 9**

six deliberately refused

SPEND ON ADS

**₹0**

the maths is on page 5

01

# What ₹25,000 a month actually buys.

Start with the constraint, not the wishlist

₹25,000 is roughly €265 or \$285 a month. That is a real budget — but it is small enough that one wrong decision consumes all of it. The two most common wrong decisions are **buying the full outbound tool stack** and **running paid ads**. Either one alone would spend the entire month with nothing left over.

## YOUR MONTHLY BUDGET

# ₹25k

≈ €265. About one billable hour at your target European rate.

## STANDARD OUTBOUND STACK

# ₹19k

Apollo + a full Instantly stack. Leaves ₹6k for everything else.

## LEANER STACK WE RECOMMEND

# ₹9.8k

Apollo sends the email itself. Same outcome at this volume.

## FREED FOR GROWTH

# ₹15k

Which is where the real decision lies — see page 4.

## SIX HONEST STATEMENTS BEFORE YOU SPEND ANYTHING

- 1 Paid ads are mathematically impossible at this budget.** Your whole month buys roughly 20–35 clicks on LinkedIn or Google for European B2B terms. That is not a campaign, it is a rounding error. The full arithmetic is on page 5.
- 2 Your website cannot currently capture a lead.** Until the form, the booking link and the domain email exist, every rupee you spend leaks out the bottom. This is a hard precondition, not an improvement.
- 3 Tools are not the bottleneck. Hours are.** You have roughly 12 marketing hours a week between two people. Spending ₹15,000 on a fourth tool buys nothing; spending it on someone to build your prospect lists buys hours.
- 4 One client will not come from one channel.** Cold email alone produces roughly one serious conversation a month. Three channels running together is what makes 90 days realistic.
- 5 The cheapest channel is the strongest one.** Partner referrals cost ₹0 and convert better than anything you can buy, because someone the buyer already trusts made the introduction.
- 6 90 days is achievable but tight.** Honest estimate: around a two-in-three chance of a first *paid* engagement by day 90, and roughly even odds of a full build. Plan for 120 days; be delighted at 90.

## THE WHOLE PLAN IN ONE LINE

**Spend ₹10k on a lean stack, ₹10k on buying back your own time, and ₹0 on advertising.**

Then run three channels — cold email, founder LinkedIn and partner outreach — for twelve consecutive weeks without changing the plan halfway through.

## THE FAILURE MODE TO AVOID

Spreading ₹25,000 thinly across seven channels so that none of them reaches the volume where it works. **Three channels done properly beats nine channels done once.** Every refusal in this document is deliberate.

## ₹25,000 IN CONTEXT — WHAT OTHERS SPEND TO WIN THE SAME CLIENT

### A Dutch agency

€3,000–8,000 a month on a marketing hire, ads and events. Roughly 12–30× your budget, chasing the same buyers.

### A funded Indian dev shop

₹2–5 lakh a month on a BD team, Clutch placement and paid search. Roughly 8–20× your budget.

### You

₹25,000 and twelve hours a week. You cannot outspend anyone, so you have to out-specific them.

### Which is survivable

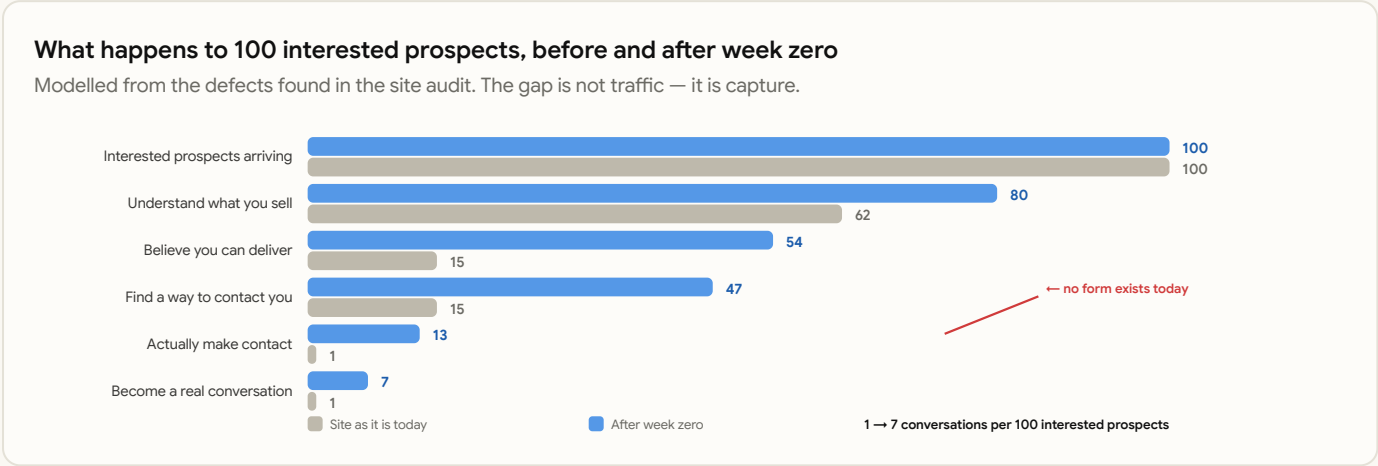
Because they are buying reach and you are buying **relevance**. Sixty messages that each name a real detail about a real company beat six thousand that do not.

02

# Week zero: stop the leak before you turn on the tap.

Roughly 20 hours of work. Do not spend a rupee on outreach until it is done.

The audit of `nexarrow.eu` found no contact form anywhere on the site, no booking link, and a Gmail address as the only route to reach you. A prospect who wants to hire you today cannot. Spending on traffic before fixing this is the most expensive mistake available to you.



THE WEEK-ZERO CHECKLIST — NOTHING HERE COSTS MONEY

- ☐ Enquiry form on the site, six fields, posting to a CRM
- ☐ Auto-reply within 60 seconds with a booking link
- ☐ Cal.com booking page, availability locked to 14:00–18:00 CET
- ☐ hello@nexarrow.eu live — remove the Gmail address
- ☐ SPF, DKIM and DMARC passing on both domains
- ☐ Buy the separate sending domain and start warming it today
- ☐ Both founders' names and photos on the site with LinkedIn links
- ☐ Delete the six phantom Insights articles
- ☐ Two case studies live — even self-funded showcase builds
- ☐ Analytics + UTM discipline so you can tell what worked

**THE ONE THAT TAKES LONGEST — START IT TODAY**

Domain warm-up takes three to four weeks. Buy the sending domain in week zero and begin warming immediately, even before the lists are built. If you skip this, your first campaign lands in spam and the domain is burned permanently. There is no shortcut and no paid way around it.

**WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS**

Marketing spend multiplies whatever your website already does. Right now it multiplies zero.

Twenty hours of unpaid work in week zero is worth more than ₹25,000 of spend in month one. Do it in the order above.

| WEEK-ZERO COST            |                 |
|---------------------------|-----------------|
| Sending domain (annual)   | ₹1,200          |
| Google Workspace, 2 seats | ₹1,250/mo       |
| Form, booking, CRM        | ₹0 — free tiers |
| Analytics                 | ₹0 — GA4        |
| Money                     | ≈ ₹2,450        |
| Your time                 | ≈ 20 hours      |

WEEK ZERO, DAY BY DAY

| DAY       | DO THIS                                                                                 | WHY IT IS FIRST                                                                                                     |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Monday    | Buy the sending domain. Switch warm-up on.                                              | It needs three to four weeks and nothing else can start without it. Every day you delay pushes outreach back a day. |
| Tuesday   | Google Workspace on nexarrow.eu. SPF, DKIM, DMARC on both domains.                      | Removes the Gmail address and establishes the sender reputation everything downstream depends on.                   |
| Wednesday | Form + CRM + auto-reply. Cal.com locked to 14:00–18:00 CET.                             | This is the actual leak. Test it from an outside address before you call it done.                                   |
| Thursday  | Both LinkedIn profiles rewritten. Names and photos on the site.                         | Half your email recipients will look you up. Give them a person to find.                                            |
| Friday    | Delete the phantom articles. Take the Apollo annual plan. First three partner messages. | Partner outreach starts in week zero, not week four — it has the longest lead time of any channel.                  |

03

Where the ₹25,000 goes.

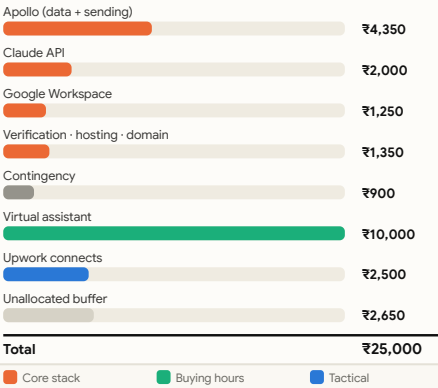
A lean stack, and one decision about the remainder

CORE STACK — NON-NEGOTIABLE, ₹9,850 A MONTH

| TOOL                                           | PLAN                   | ₹ / MONTH | WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Apollo.io                                      | Basic, annual          | 4,350     | Prospect data and email sequencing in one tool. At 60 sends a week you need nothing else — this one choice saves ≈₹9,000/month.                                                                 |
| Google Workspace                               | 2 seats                | 1,250     | Kills the Gmail address. Domain email, aliases, and the sender reputation everything else depends on.                                                                                           |
| Claude API                                     | Pay as you go          | 2,000     | Research briefs, proposal drafts, client reports. The cheapest hour you will buy.                                                                                                               |
| Verification, hosting & sending domain         | Credits · Hetzner CX22 | 1,350     | Bounces above 3% throttle the domain, so verify before every send. Hetzner runs n8n in an EU region. And never cold-mail from nexarrow.eu — if the sending domain burns, the real one survives. |
| Contingency                                    | —                      | 900       | Top-ups and overages. Budget it, or it eats the growth line.                                                                                                                                    |
| CRM · forms · booking · analytics · scheduling |                        | 0         | HubSpot free, Tally, Cal.com, GA4, cron. Genuinely free at your volume — do not pay for these in year one.                                                                                      |

The ₹25,000, allocated

Recommended split. The growth line is the only real decision.



THE SAVING THAT MAKES THIS WORK

The standard advice is Apollo for data plus Instantly for sending. A working Instantly stack runs roughly **\$124–180 a month** once leads and CRM modules are added — around ₹11,000–16,000 on its own.

At 60 emails a week you do not need it. **Apollo sends sequences itself.** Revisit a dedicated sender only when you exceed roughly 400 sends a week — which, on your hours, you will not this year.

THE REMAINING ₹15,000 — PICK ONE, NOT THREE

A · Buy hours

DO THIS

A part-time VA, 15–20 hours a month, at ₹10,000. They build the lists, verify emails, research each company and keep the CRM clean.

Buys back ≈ 6 hours a week, leaves ₹5,000 buffer. List building eats most of your 12 marketing hours — removing it roughly doubles the volume you can sustain, cheaper per conversation than any tool you could buy instead.

B · Buy reach

MONTH 3+

Sales Navigator Core (≈ ₹8,000) for precise targeting, plus Upwork Connects (₹2,500) for the first-review play on page 11.

Verify the India price first — LinkedIn's regional pricing differs from the US list price. Only worth it if you will use it weekly; otherwise it is ₹8,000 of guilt sitting in your subscriptions.

C · Buy clicks

DO NOT

₹15,000 into LinkedIn or Google Ads buys roughly 15–25 clicks, 0–1 leads and approximately zero clients.

Not a judgement about advertising — about this budget. The arithmetic is overleaf, and it is not close.

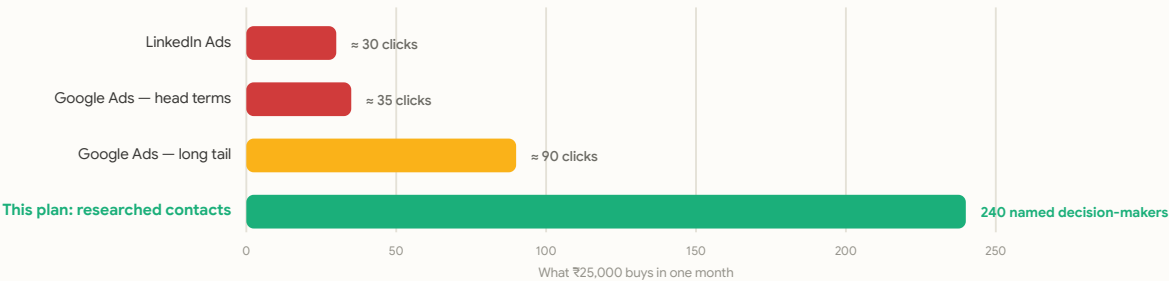
04

Why paid ads are out — with the numbers.

You asked about ads specifically, so here is the honest arithmetic rather than an opinion

What ₹25,000 buys on each advertising platform, per month

Indicative cost-per-click for B2B software-services targeting in the Netherlands and the Nordics. Verify against live auction data before acting — but the order of magnitude is what matters here.



| PLATFORM                                             | TYPICAL CPC | CLICKS FOR ₹25K | LEADS EXPECTED | VERDICT                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LinkedIn Ads<br>Sponsored content, EU B2B            | €7–12       | 22–38           | 0–1            | <div>NO</div> The best B2B targeting available anywhere, and completely unaffordable at this scale. LinkedIn also enforces a practical daily minimum that would drain the budget in under three weeks. |
| Google Search Ads<br>High-intent commercial terms    | €5–15       | 18–53           | 0–2            | <div>NO</div> Terms like “software development company netherlands” are bid up by agencies with fifty times your budget. You would be buying the cheapest, least-qualified clicks left in the auction. |
| Google Ads — long tail<br>Ultra-specific, low volume | €2–5        | 50–130          | 1–3            | <div>MONTH 4+</div> The only defensible ad play in this document. Bid on five or six very narrow phrases only, with a ₹4,000 test — <b>after</b> the site converts and case studies exist.             |
| Meta / Instagram                                     | €0.4–1.5    | 180–650         | ≈ 0            | <div>NO</div> Cheap clicks from entirely the wrong audience. A Dutch operations director is not buying custom software from an Instagram ad.                                                           |

THE COMPARISON THAT SETTLES IT

₹25,000 on LinkedIn Ads ≈ 30 clicks

₹25,000 on the plan in this document ≈ 240 researched, named decision-makers contacted

Thirty anonymous clicks against two hundred and forty named humans who received a message written specifically about their company. At your stage that is not a close call.

WHEN ADS DO START MAKING SENSE

- Two or three **real case studies** live on the site.
- The site **converts measurably** — you know its enquiry rate, not just its traffic.
- You can commit **₹40,000+ a month for three months**. Below that you cannot gather enough data to optimise, so you are buying noise.

Roughly a month-six conversation, funded by client revenue rather than savings.

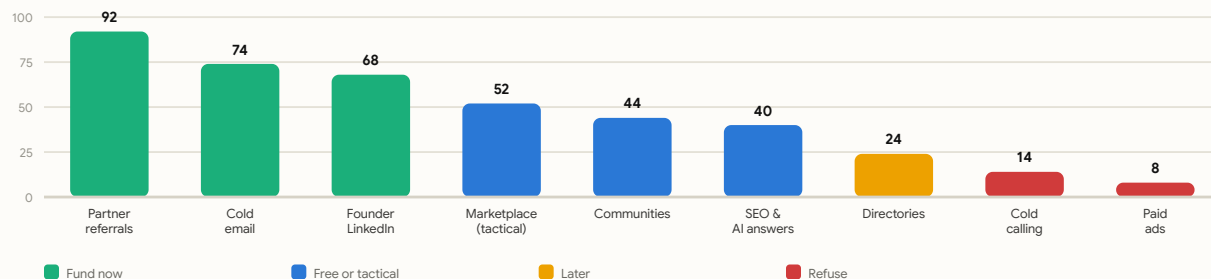
05

## Every channel, judged.

Nine options. Three funded, three deferred, three refused.

### Expected return per rupee and per hour, for this company at this stage

Scored 0–100. A channel that works brilliantly for a funded thirty-person agency can score badly here — this is a judgement about *your* constraints.



| CHANNEL                                                                         | VERDICT     | ₹ / MONTH | HOURS / WK | REASONING                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | FIRST RESULT  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Partner referrals</b><br>EU agencies, fractional CTOs, e-Residency providers | FUND IT     | 0         | 3          | Highest yield available to you, and free. A studio that sells websites but subcontracts anything complex sends pre-trusted work forever. Being small is an advantage here — agencies fear large partners poaching clients. | Weeks 4–10    |
| <b>Cold email</b><br>Apollo data + Apollo sequences                             | FUND IT     | 5,150     | 5          | The only channel you fully control, and the only one producing pipeline on a schedule. Needs real per-prospect research, a warmed domain and country-by-country legal care.                                                | Weeks 5–9     |
| <b>Founder LinkedIn</b><br>Personal profiles, organic                           | FUND IT     | 0         | 3          | Free, slow, permanently useful. Mostly it makes cold email work better — a prospect who checks you finds a real person, not a blank profile. Post from <b>personal</b> profiles.                                           | Weeks 6–14    |
| <b>Freelance marketplaces</b><br>Upwork, tactical use only                      | TACTICAL    | 2,500     | 2          | Contradicts the positioning and attracts price-led buyers — but it is the fastest route to a first client and a first public review. Defensible <b>once</b> . Boundaries on page 11.                                       | Weeks 3–8     |
| <b>Communities</b><br>e-Residency, Estonian founders, niche Slacks              | FREE, DO IT | 0         | 1          | Low volume, zero cost, occasionally excellent. Your Estonian entity gives you real standing where other Indian suppliers have none.                                                                                        | Unpredictable |
| <b>SEO &amp; AI answer engines</b>                                              | COMPOUND    | 0         | 1          | Nothing this quarter; compounds indefinitely after. One hour a week, blocked until the crawlability fixes ship.                                                                                                            | Months 6–12   |
| <b>Directories</b><br>Clutch, Sortlist, GoodFirms                               | WAIT        | 0         | —          | Needs verified reviews you do not have. Create the free profiles now so they age; pay for nothing.                                                                                                                         | Month 8+      |
| <b>Paid advertising</b>                                                         | REFUSE      | 0         | —          | See page 5 — thirty clicks a month is not a channel. Cold calling is refused for the same reason in reverse: your only calling window is the four hours you should spend on booked meetings.                               | Not this year |

Funded: partnerships, cold email, LinkedIn. Total cost **₹5,150 a month** in channel spend — everything else in the budget is stack and time.

That is the point. At this size the money goes into **capability and hours**, not into media. The channels themselves are almost free; what they cost is consistency.

06

# Channel one: the cold email engine.

60 researched prospects a week · ₹5,150 a month · 5 hours a week

## STEP 1 · BUILD THE LIST IN APOLLO — THE EXACT FILTERS

| FILTER         | SETTING                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Country        | Netherlands, Sweden, Denmark, Finland, Ireland. Not Germany — see the legal note below.                                                  |
| Employees      | 25 – 250                                                                                                                                 |
| Industry       | Logistics & supply chain · manufacturing & industrial · wholesale & distribution · professional services · construction & field services |
| Job titles     | Operations Director · COO · Head of Operations · Finance Director · Managing Director · Owner                                            |
| Exclude titles | CTO · VP Engineering · Head of IT. A CTO builds in-house and will not buy from you.                                                      |
| Exclude        | Anyone contacted in the last six months · agencies · other dev shops · companies under €3m revenue                                       |
| Verify         | Every address, before it enters a sequence. Bounce rate must stay under 3%.                                                              |

### WEEKLY VOLUME

|                      |                |
|----------------------|----------------|
| Researched prospects | 60 / week      |
| Per mailbox per day  | 25–30 max      |
| Mailboxes needed     | 2              |
| Touches per prospect | 5 over 24 days |
| Monthly contacts     | ≈ 240          |

Do not exceed this. More volume without more research lowers the reply rate and raises the spam rate simultaneously. Sixty well-researched beats six hundred templated.

### DO NOT COLD-EMAIL GERMANY

German unfair-competition law treats unsolicited commercial email as an infringement absent consent, and it is actively enforced — including by competitors. Germany is your biggest market and it is worth entering properly: **LinkedIn, partners and referrals only.**

For the Netherlands, the Nordics and Ireland, B2B contact is workable with a documented legitimate interest, clear sender identity and a working opt-out. Have a lawyer review your sequence once before the first send.

## STEP 2 · ADD A TRIGGER — THE REASON TO WRITE *THIS WEEK*

### Highest-converting trigger

A developer or “digital transformation” role posted 45+ days ago and still open. That means funded, unstaffed work and a frustrated hiring manager. Check LinkedIn Jobs, Indeed NL, Nationale Vacaturebank, Jobindex (DK) and company careers pages.

### Other usable triggers

- New warehouse, branch or country announced
- Funding round or acquisition
- Announced ERP or CRM migration
- Job ads listing a visibly legacy stack
- In a NIS2 in-scope sector

## STEP 3 · DELIVERABILITY — THE RULES THAT KEEP YOU OUT OF SPAM

### Separate domain

Send from **nexarrow-team.com**, never **nexarrow.eu**. If it burns, your client mail and real domain survive.

### Warm for 3–4 weeks

Start the day you buy the domain. There is no paid shortcut, and skipping it puts you in spam permanently.

### Plain text only

No images, no HTML signature, no tracking pixels. Pixels hurt deliverability and weaken your legal position in the EU.

### Full identity + opt-out

Legal name, registry code, address and a working one-click unsubscribe honoured within 24 hours. Non-negotiable.

## WHAT A FINISHED PROSPECT RECORD LOOKS LIKE BEFORE YOU WRITE ANYTHING

|                     |                           |
|---------------------|---------------------------|
| Company             | Dutch logistics, 90 staff |
| Contact · email     | Ops Director · verified   |
| Trigger             | Dev role open 61 days     |
| Second signal       | New Antwerp depot         |
| Opening observation | the stale job ad          |
| Angle if no reply   | EU contracting            |

Six fields. If the last two are empty the prospect is **not ready to contact** — put them back in the list.

**This record is the whole job.** The email writes itself in four minutes once the research exists. It is also exactly the work you hand to a VA — which is why Option A on page 4 buys more than any tool.

07

# The five-touch sequence, written out.

Copy these, then replace every bracket with something you actually researched

## DAY 1 · THE OBSERVATION

**Subject:** your [warehouse ops / approvals] setup

Hi [First name],

I noticed [Company] has had a [role] opening live since [month] – usually that means there is work queued up that nobody has capacity to build.

We are a small Estonian software company. We build internal tools for European operations teams – the approvals, records and reporting systems that end up living in spreadsheets.

Out of curiosity: is that backlog mostly new features, or is it the internal process side?

Manish

Nexarrow OÜ · Tallinn · Reg. 17521430

Rules: under 90 words. One specific verifiable observation. No attachment, no calendar link, no pitch. Ends with a single easy question. If you cannot write a true first line about them, remove them from the list.

## DAY 8 · THE PROOF

**Subject:** re: your [warehouse ops] setup

Hi [First name],

Following up with something concrete rather than another nudge.

We built an approvals tool for a [sector] company running the same process across email and Excel. Forty minutes per approval became about three, and the audit trail stopped being a spreadsheet. Five weeks, fixed price.

Short write-up here if useful: [link]

Manish

Rules: one case study, two sentences of context, one number. Still no calendar link. You are demonstrating, not asking.

## DAY 4 · LINKEDIN, NOT EMAIL

Send a connection request from your personal profile. Either no note, or one line:

Hi [First name] – we build internal software for European operations teams. Following [Company]'s expansion into [market] with interest.

This warms the name before email two lands. A prospect who has seen your face accepts a second email far more readily than a stranger.

## DAY 15 · CHANGE THE ANGLE

**Subject:** the EU contracting question

Hi [First name],

Different angle, then I will leave it.

Most companies your size that consider outside development stall on procurement rather than price – who am I contracting with, where does our data sit, who signs the DPA.

We are an EU-registered company with an EU VAT number, so you get a normal intra-community invoice and a DPA under EU law. Our engineers are in India and we are online 14:00–18:00 CET every working day.

If that combination is useful, worth twenty minutes?

Manish

Most replies arrive here. The first angle simply missed. This is also the email that plays your strongest card – the EU entity – which almost no competitor can match.

## DAY 24 · CLOSE THE LOOP

**Subject:** closing this off

Hi [First name],

I will stop here so I am not cluttering your inbox. If internal tooling becomes a priority later, just reply to this thread and I will pick it up.

Good luck with [specific thing].

Manish

Generates a surprising number of replies and protects the relationship. Then stop. Do not re-enter the same contact for six months.

08

Channel two: LinkedIn,  
from your own face.

₹0 · 3 hours a week · the channel that makes the other two work better

FIX THE PROFILE FIRST — ONE HOUR, THEN NEVER AGAIN

| ELEMENT  | WHAT IT SHOULD SAY                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Headline | Not “Founder at Nexarrow”. Write: <i>“We build internal software for European SMEs — EU entity, EU VAT, EU-hours delivery”</i> . This line appears next to every comment you ever make. |
| Banner   | One sentence describing who you help and one proof point. Free to make.                                                                                                                 |
| About    | Three short paragraphs: the problem you solve, who for, what happens next. Written to a Dutch operations director, not to a recruiter.                                                  |
| Featured | Two case studies and the booking link. This is your landing page inside LinkedIn.                                                                                                       |
| Photo    | A real, current, well-lit photograph. Non-negotiable for remote five-figure deals.                                                                                                      |

THE WEEKLY RHYTHM — 3 HOURS, WRITTEN IN ONE SUNDAY SITTING

| SLOT          | WHAT GOES IN IT                                                                                                                   |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 20:00 IST | A problem you saw in a real system, and how you would fix it. No promotion.                                                       |
| Wed 20:00 IST | Something visual — a before/after screenshot, an architecture sketch, a real number.                                              |
| Fri 20:00 IST | A short opinion on an EU-specific topic: data residency, the AI Act, e-invoicing, EU hosting.                                     |
| Daily, 15 min | Comment properly on five posts by people in your target market. This builds more reach than posting does in the first two months. |

20:00 IST is roughly 15:30 CET — the European mid-afternoon, when your buyers are actually on LinkedIn. Schedule everything on Sunday; never write on the day.

WHY THIS MATTERS MORE THAN IT LOOKS

LinkedIn will not produce your first client directly. It will do something more valuable: **make your cold email work**.

Roughly half of the people who receive a cold email from you will look you up before replying. If they find a real person posting useful things about their industry, your reply rate rises materially. If they find an empty profile, it falls.

CONNECTION TARGETS

|                   |                  |
|-------------------|------------------|
| Requests per week | 20–25            |
| Who               | Your exact ICP   |
| Note              | One line or none |
| Pitch on connect? | Never            |

Stay under 25 a week or LinkedIn restricts the account. Wait until they have seen two or three of your posts before any conversation. The people who accept become the warm audience your posts land in front of.

WHAT NOT TO POST

AI hot takes, “10 tips” lists, motivational founder content, anything reposted, anything obviously AI-written. It attracts other agencies rather than buyers — and your buyers read AI-generated content all day and recognise it immediately.

WHAT TO ACTUALLY POST — FOUR PILLARS, WITH OPENERS YOU CAN USE

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>1 • Real numbers</div> <div>A specific technical decision with a measurable outcome. Highest engagement, hardest to fake.</div> <div><i>“An approval that took 40 minutes now takes 3. Here is what actually changed — and it was not the software.”</i></div> | <div>2 • EU operating knowledge</div> <div>Data residency, the AI Act, reverse-charge invoicing. Very few technical people write about this and your buyers care about it.</div> <div><i>“If your developers in a third country can open your production database, that is a transfer. Most SMEs have not documented it.”</i></div> | <div>3 • Honest pricing</div> <div>What this kind of build actually costs. Buyers hunting for this are high-intent and grateful.</div> <div><i>“What a custom approvals tool really costs in 2026, and the three things that move the number.”</i></div> | <div>4 • Teardowns</div> <div>A bad internal process, analysed properly. Recognisable, useful, and it demonstrates judgement rather than claiming it.</div> <div><i>“Six spreadsheets, four email threads and one person who remembers everything. A very normal quoting process.”</i></div> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**One rule:** every post must come from something you actually did or actually saw. You have twelve weeks of real work ahead of you — that is twelve weeks of material. The moment you start inventing content to fill a slot, the channel stops working.

09

Channel three: partners.  
Free, and the likeliest to work.

₹0 · 3 hours a week · three new conversations every week without exception

WHO TO APPROACH, AND WHERE TO FIND THEM

| PARTNER TYPE                                                               | WHY THEY NEED YOU · WHERE TO FIND THEM                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Design & branding studios<br>Netherlands, Sweden, Denmark                  | They sell websites and brand work, then subcontract anything with a database behind it. Search <a href="#">Dribbble</a> , <a href="#">Clutch</a> (filter: design, NL/SE, 5–20 staff), and <a href="#">Awwwards</a> . |
| Fractional CTOs & IT consultants                                           | They diagnose problems and write recommendations, but do not build. LinkedIn title search: “fractional CTO”, “interim CTO”, “IT consultant” + country.                                                               |
| e-Residency service providers<br>Xolo, Enty, Comistar, 1Office and similar | <b>Your natural home.</b> Their clients are exactly your ICP and you share a jurisdiction. Also the e-Residency community forums and Estonian founder groups.                                                        |
| Small ERP & CRM implementers                                               | They hit custom-integration walls constantly and lose the work. Search partner directories for Odoo, Exact, Visma and Business Central resellers.                                                                    |
| Non-competing dev shops                                                    | Different specialism, overflow work, holiday cover. Mobile-only or data-only shops that get asked for internal tooling.                                                                                              |

ADDRESS THEIR REAL FEAR FIRST

Every agency's first thought is “will this dev shop steal my client?”

Put the **written no-poach commitment** in the first message, before they raise it. It costs you nothing and it removes the single largest objection in the conversation.

WHAT TO OFFER

|                     |                         |
|---------------------|-------------------------|
| Referral fee        | 10–15% of first project |
| or white-label rate | ≈ 20% below list        |
| Whose brand         | Their choice            |
| No-poach clause     | In writing, always      |
| Scoping turnaround  | Under 48 hours          |

A partner's own reputation is on the line with their client, so responsiveness matters more to them than price. Be the partner who answers fastest.

THE OUTREACH MESSAGE — SEND THIS, NOT A TEMPLATE

**Subject:** dev capacity for [Studio]'s bigger projects

Hi [First name],

I run a small Estonian software company. We build internal tools and back-end systems for European SMEs.

I am reaching out to studios like yours because the pattern I keep seeing is: a client asks for something with real logic behind it, and it either gets turned down or handed to whoever is free.

Two things that usually matter: we work white-label under your brand if you prefer, and we will sign a written no-poach clause — your client stays your client, permanently.

Worth a twenty-minute call to see if we are a fit for your overflow?

Manish · Nexarrow OÜ · Tallinn

EXPECT THIS RATIO

Three conversations a week for twelve weeks is **36 conversations**. Expect roughly 10 to reply, 4 to have a call, and 2 to become genuinely active. That ratio is normal — do not read it as failure.

Give before you ask. Send them a lead, review a client's architecture free, or solve one small thing. The partners who send you work are the ones who received something first.

THE TRACKER — FIVE COLUMNS, ONE ROW PER PARTNER, REVIEWED EVERY SUNDAY

| PARTNER               | TYPE                 | STAGE     | LAST CONTACT | NEXT ACTION & DATE                                    |
|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Studio Voorhaven (NL) | Design studio        | ACTIVE    | 12 Aug       | Send the architecture note they asked for — by 15 Aug |
| H. Lindqvist (SE)     | Fractional CTO       | CALL HELD | 08 Aug       | Follow up with the white-label rate card — by 14 Aug  |
| Enty / Xolo (EE)      | e-Residency provider | REPLIED   | 05 Aug       | Propose 20 minutes next week — by 13 Aug              |

...plus every partner contacted, including the ones who never replied. Ten targets to reach two active partners is the normal ratio — the tracker is what stops you quietly abandoning the channel after four silent weeks.

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# The tactical shortcut — used once, then closed.

If “one client” is the actual goal, this is the fastest legal route to it

Earlier advice in this series told you to avoid freelance marketplaces because they attract price-led buyers and contradict the EU-entity positioning. That remains true as a **channel**. But your stated goal is one client in ninety days, and the honest position is this: Upwork is the only place where a supplier with no reviews can win paid work in three weeks.

## HOW TO USE IT WITHOUT DAMAGING THE POSITIONING

- 1 Treat it as a proof factory, not a revenue channel.** The objective is one completed contract, one five-star public review and one written testimonial. Not a pipeline.
- 2 Bid only on jobs that match the real offer.** Internal tools, dashboards, workflow automation, integrations — for European clients. Ignore everything else regardless of budget.
- 3 Price at a discount, once, deliberately.** Around 30–40% below your list rate, in exchange for a review and permission to write it up as a case study. Put that exchange in writing before you start.
- 4 Cap it at two contracts.** After the second review, stop bidding entirely. Beyond that point the platform starts costing you more in positioning than it returns in cash.
- 5 Do not mention Upwork anywhere else.** The case study says “a Dutch logistics company”, not “a client we found on Upwork”. That is not deception — it is simply not relevant to the next buyer.

## THE PROPOSAL OPENER THAT WORKS

You are describing an approvals process running across email and spreadsheets, with no audit trail.

We build exactly this. Two questions before I say anything about ourselves:

1. Roughly how many approvals go through per week?
2. Does the audit trail need to satisfy anyone external, or is it internal only?

For context: we are an EU-registered company (Estonia, VAT-registered), and we can work in your afternoon — 14:00–18:00 CET, every working day.

Lead with their problem and two real questions. Ninety percent of competing proposals open with “I have 8 years of experience”. Yours opens by proving you read the brief.

## BE CLEAR ABOUT THE TRADE

You are exchanging **margin and positioning** for **speed and proof**. That is a reasonable trade exactly once, when you have zero reviews and zero case studies. It is a bad trade in month six.

Write the exit condition down now: **two reviews, then stop**. Decisions like this are easy to make in advance and very hard to make when a ₹60,000 contract is on screen.

## COST AND EXPECTED RETURN

|                     |                  |
|---------------------|------------------|
| Connects budget     | ₹2,500 / mo      |
| Proposals per week  | 5–8              |
| Time per proposal   | 15–20 min        |
| Expected interviews | 2–4 / month      |
| Expected contract   | 1 in 4–8 weeks   |
| Typical first value | ₹40,000–1,20,000 |

Small money. But a first paying client, a public review and a real case study unlock every other channel in this document — and they are what the site is missing.

## ALTERNATIVE IF YOU REFUSE THIS

Take one deliberately discounted Estonian or Baltic client instead. Same effect — a named reference and a real case study — without the marketplace. Slower to find, better for positioning, and it strengthens the Estonian story. Either route is defensible; doing neither is not.

## WHICH JOBS TO BID ON

- **Client in Europe** — keeps the case study on-message.
- **Budget above €2,000**, or hourly above €30.
- **Internal tools, dashboards, integrations, automation.** Your actual offer.
- **Payment verified**, posted under 24 hours ago, under fifteen proposals.

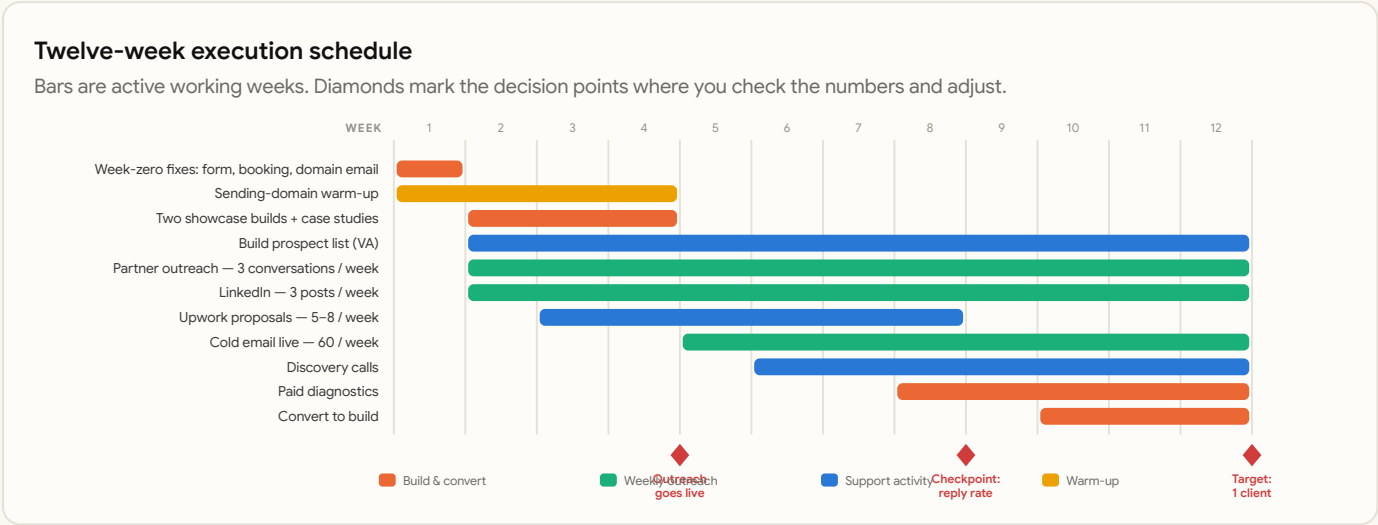
## WALK AWAY FROM

- “Lowest bid wins”, or a stated hourly under €15.
- Vague scope with a fixed price — an unpaid rewrite waiting to happen.
- Daily availability in European *morning* hours. You cannot deliver it, so do not promise it.
- Long-term full-time-equivalent roles. You have twelve hours a week.

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The ninety days,  
week by week.

Twelve weeks. Same three channels every week. No mid-course changes before week eight.



| WEEKS | PHASE                   | WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS                                                                                                                                                                                                             | GATE — DO NOT MOVE ON UNTIL                                                                 |
|-------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0     | Fix the leak            | The week-zero checklist on page 3. Buy and start warming the sending domain. Set up Apollo, the CRM and the booking page. Rewrite both LinkedIn profiles.                                                                         | An enquiry submitted by an outsider reaches the CRM and triggers a reply within 60 seconds. |
| 1–3   | Build proof and lists   | Domain warms in the background. Ship two showcase builds and write them up. Build the first 200-prospect list. Start LinkedIn posting. Begin partner outreach — three conversations a week from week one. Start Upwork proposals. | Two case studies live on the site and 200 verified prospects in Apollo.                     |
| 4–8   | Outreach at full volume | Cold email goes live at 60 a week. Partner conversations continue. LinkedIn three posts a week. First calls start landing. Sell the €1,900 diagnostic, not the build.                                                             | Reply rate above 5% and at least three real conversations held.                             |
| 9–12  | Convert                 | Push the strongest three conversations to a paid diagnostic. Convert one diagnostic into a build. Keep sending — the temptation to stop outreach the moment a deal looks close is what creates the month-four gap.                | One signed paid engagement.                                                                 |

The week that gets skipped

Week zero. It has no visible output, so it feels like delay. Skipping it means every message you send for the next twelve weeks lands somewhere that cannot convert.

The rule that protects the plan

No new channels before week eight. When week five produces nothing, the instinct is to add something. Adding a fourth channel halves the attention on the three that need volume to work.

The habit that decides it

Three partner conversations every week, without exception, even in the weeks when a client deal looks imminent. This is the channel most likely to produce client one, and it is the easiest to quietly drop.

WHERE THE TWELVE MARKETING HOURS GO EACH WEEK

| ACTIVITY                                           | HOURS | OWNER  | WHEN IN THE WEEK                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cold email — review lists, write first lines, send | 5     | Demand | Tue and Thu evenings, 20:00–22:30 IST                                           |
| Partner outreach — 3 new conversations             | 3     | Demand | Monday evening. First thing in the week, before anything else can crowd it out. |
| LinkedIn — write and schedule 3 posts              | 2     | Both   | Sunday, in one sitting. Never on the day.                                       |
| Upwork proposals — 5 to 8                          | 1.5   | Demand | Wednesday evening                                                               |
| Sunday review — the seven numbers                  | 0.5   | Both   | Sunday, same time every week                                                    |

Calls sit outside this budget and take priority over all of it. Every booked call goes in the 14:00–18:00 CET window, which is your 18:30–22:30 IST — the reason this model works at all.

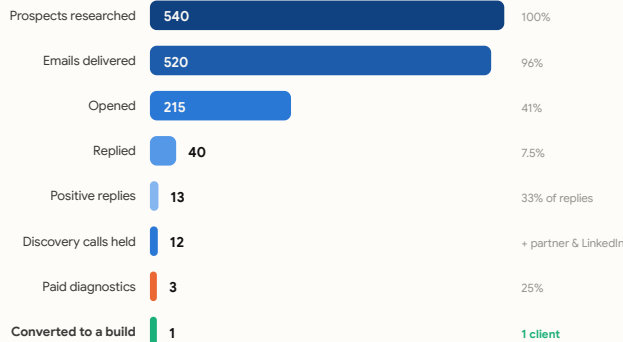
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# What it actually takes to land one client.

Conservative rates, multiplied out, across ninety days

## Ninety days of activity, converted step by step

Cold email at 60 a week from week four; partner and LinkedIn activity from week one. Conservative benchmarks for well-researched, low-volume EU B2B outreach.



Across 90 days. Calls include partner and LinkedIn sources, which is why that step rises rather than falls.

## THE HONEST ANSWER

# 1–2

paid engagements across ninety days, if all three channels run every week. Roughly **two-in-three odds** of a first paid diagnostic and **roughly even odds** of a full build inside the window.

Cold email alone produces about one serious conversation a month. That is why the answer depends on running three channels rather than perfecting one.

## WHERE THE CLIENT IS MOST LIKELY TO COME FROM

|                                |       |
|--------------------------------|-------|
| Partner referral               | ≈ 40% |
| Cold email                     | ≈ 30% |
| Marketplace / discounted first | ≈ 20% |
| LinkedIn inbound               | ≈ 10% |

Note the order. The free channel is the most likely source, and it is the one that requires no budget at all — only three conversations a week.

## COST PER OUTCOME — WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY BUYING

### 90-DAY SPEND

# ₹75k

Three months at ₹25,000. Plus roughly 150 hours of your own time.

### COST PER CONVERSATION

# ₹5–7k

Around 12 real conversations across the quarter.

### COST PER CLIENT

# ₹40–75k

Against a first engagement worth ₹1,900–18,000.

### PAYBACK

# 1 build

A single ₹9,500 build repays roughly eleven months of this budget.

**Read that last tile carefully.** One completed build covers this entire marketing budget for almost a year. That is what makes ₹25,000 a month a rational spend even though it cannot buy advertising — the economics work because your deal size is large relative to your cost base, not because the budget is big.

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# The weekly scorecard, and what to fix when it misses.

Seven numbers, reviewed every Sunday in fifteen minutes

| NUMBER                       | WEEKLY TARGET | OWNER       | IF IT MISSES TWO WEEKS RUNNING, CHANGE THIS                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prospects researched & added | 60            | VA / Demand | This is the one that quietly fails first. If the VA is not hitting it, the brief is unclear — write the Apollo filters down and give them the trigger checklist from page 7. |
| Emails delivered             | 55+           | Demand      | A gap between researched and delivered means bounces. Check verification is running before send and that the bounce rate is under 3%.                                        |
| Reply rate                   | > 5%          | Demand      | <b>Below 4% means the list or the first line is wrong — never that the volume is too low.</b> Rewrite the first line to be about them. Do not increase sends.                |
| Positive replies             | 1–2           | Demand      | Replies but no positives means the offer is landing wrong. Try leading with the EU-contracting angle instead of the technology one.                                          |
| Partner conversations        | 3             | Demand      | The most commonly dropped commitment in the plan. Put three named partner targets in the calendar every Monday morning before anything else.                                 |
| LinkedIn posts               | 3             | Both        | If you are writing on the day, you will stop by week three. Write all three in one Sunday sitting and schedule them.                                                         |
| Calls booked                 | 1             | Demand      | The output metric. Zero for three consecutive weeks means stop sending and re-examine the ICP before spending another rupee.                                                 |

## IF WEEK 8 ARRIVES WITH NOTHING

Do not add a channel and do not increase spend. Check these four things, in this order:

- 1 Is the list actually the ICP?** Pull twenty contacts at random. If more than three are the wrong size, sector or title, the list is the problem.
- 2 Is the first line about them or about you?** Read your last twenty first lines. If they would work unchanged for any company, that is the problem.
- 3 Are the emails arriving?** Send to a test inbox on Gmail, Outlook and a corporate domain. If they land in spam, everything upstream is irrelevant.
- 4 Is there anything to believe?** If the site still has no case study, the failure is not the outreach — it is that there is nothing on the other end of the click.

## THE SUNDAY REVIEW

**Fifteen minutes. Same time every week.**

|                                  |       |
|----------------------------------|-------|
| Read the seven numbers           | 5 min |
| Pick the week's three priorities | 5 min |
| Schedule the LinkedIn posts      | 5 min |

No strategy discussion. Strategy is a monthly conversation — allowed into the weekly review, it expands to fill the hour and the week never gets planned.

## Do not track

Website visits, LinkedIn impressions, follower count, emails sent. They move without meaning and they feel like progress. If a number cannot change a decision, it is decoration.

## THE MONTHLY QUESTION — ASKED ONCE, ON THE FIRST SUNDAY

### Is the budget in the right place?

If the VA is not producing 60 researched prospects a week, that ₹10,000 is buying nothing — fix the brief or move the money.

### Which channel produced the conversations?

Tag every enquiry at source. By month three you should know which of the three is carrying the plan, and be able to shift hours toward it.

### What can we stop doing?

One activity removed every month. A part-time company dies of accumulation, not of missing tactics.

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## After client one — and what to do on Monday.

### WHAT CHANGES ONCE THE FIRST CLIENT SIGNS

| THEN ADD                                   | ₹ / MONTH | WHY IT BECOMES WORTH IT ONLY NOW                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Clutch & directory profiles                | 0         | You finally have a verified review to put on them. Free listings, no paid placement.                  |
| Sales Navigator                            | ≈ 8,000   | Worth it once you know which company profile converts, so the targeting has something to aim at.      |
| A dedicated sender<br>Instantly or similar | ≈ 4,000   | Only above roughly 400 sends a week. Below that, Apollo's own sequencing is sufficient.               |
| Google Ads, long tail                      | 4,000     | A genuine test on five or six narrow phrases — <b>after</b> the site converts and case studies exist. |
| Second VA or contractor                    | 10,000+   | Funded by client revenue, not by the marketing budget. This is how the plan scales.                   |

The rule for month four: every addition is funded by revenue, not by increasing the ₹25,000. If client one has not landed, the answer is never a bigger budget — it is one of the four diagnoses on page 14.

### MONDAY MORNING — THE FIRST SEVEN THINGS

- ☐ **Buy the sending domain** and switch warm-up on. It needs three weeks and nothing else can start without it.
- ☐ **Set up Google Workspace** on nexarrow.eu and delete the Gmail address from the site.
- ☐ **Put a form and a Cal.com link** on the site. Test both from an outside address.
- ☐ **Take the Apollo Basic annual plan** — ₹4,350 a month, and it replaces two other tools.
- ☐ **Rewrite both LinkedIn headlines** using the line on page 9. Ten minutes each.
- ☐ **Write down three partner names** and send all three messages before Friday.
- ☐ **Put the Sunday review in both calendars** as a recurring event. Start it this week, before there is anything to review.

### A NOTE ON THE NUMBERS IN THIS DOCUMENT

Tool prices are indicative at the time of writing and were checked against published 2026 pricing pages — Apollo Basic at \$49/user/month on annual billing, Instantly's Growth plan at \$37.60–47 with a realistic working stack of \$124–180, and Sales Navigator Core at roughly \$90–120. **Verify each before you subscribe**, and check LinkedIn's India regional pricing specifically. Conversions use approximately ₹95 to the euro and ₹88 to the dollar.

### IF YOU ONLY DO THREE THINGS

- 1 **Make the site capable of capturing a lead.** Twenty hours, ₹0, and it decides whether everything else is worth doing.
- 2 **Three partner conversations every single week.** Free, and the most likely source of client one.
- 3 **Sixty researched emails a week for twelve straight weeks.** The consistency matters more than the copy.

And one thing not to do: **do not spend a rupee on advertising this quarter.** The maths on page 5 does not change with better creative.

### THE PLAN, ON ONE LINE

|                      |                    |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| Stack                | ₹9,850             |
| Buying back hours    | ₹10,000            |
| Marketplace connects | ₹2,500             |
| Buffer               | ₹2,650             |
| <b>Total</b>         | <b>₹25,000</b>     |
| Advertising          | ₹0                 |
| Channels running     | 3                  |
| Hours a week         | 12                 |
| Target               | 1 client by day 90 |

### WHAT IS MODELLED RATHER THAN MEASURED

The capture model on page 3, the click estimates on page 5, the channel scores on page 6 and the entire funnel on page 13 are estimates built on conservative industry benchmarks and on the site audit conducted earlier. They are intended to be argued with and re-run once you have your own numbers — which, by week eight, you will.